

Standard Operating Procedure

Non-Formulary Medication Request

«Hospital Name» — Supports MOM.2.f

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By	Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____		
Approved By	Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____		

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» evaluates, authorises, and ratifies a request for a medication not on the current formulary.

A formulary is the hospital's approved, standing list of medications — chosen by the Medication Management Committee for safety, effectiveness, and cost — that any doctor can prescribe without special permission. A non-formulary medication is any drug not on that list. It is not banned; it simply needs a documented clinical reason and sign-off before it is procured or dispensed, because it has not gone through the committee's standard review.

2. Scope

Applies to every non-formulary medication request from a treating doctor.

3. Responsibility

Requesting Doctor / Medication Management Committee: the doctor justifies the request; the committee authorises, ratifies, and decides on formulary inclusion.

4. Procedure

1. Before requesting, check the current formulary to confirm the medication — or a suitable formulary alternative — is genuinely unavailable on it.
2. The requesting doctor states the clinical justification for the non-formulary medication in writing — why the formulary alternatives are not suitable for this patient.
3. A designated authority (Medical Superintendent or delegate) authorises the one-off use before the pharmacy procures or dispenses it. This authorisation covers this specific patient and occasion only — it does not make the drug available for general use.
4. The Medication Management Committee ratifies the request at its next meeting, confirming the authorisation and justification were appropriate.
5. Where a medication is requested repeatedly (the hospital's threshold: three or more times in six months), the committee reviews it for potential formulary inclusion using its standard evaluation criteria — evidence base, safety, and cost — and records the decision either way.

5. Records

Supported by Records 9 and 10 of the MOM.2 Required Records pack: Non-Formulary Medication Request Record and Non-Formulary Inclusion Decision Log.

6. Related Documents

- Policy on Hospital Formulary (HCO/MOM/POL/02) — MOM.2 policy, Section 5.6 (non-formulary medication process)

7. Review

Reviewed annually, and immediately after any adverse event involving a non-formulary medication.

8. References

- American Society of Health-System Pharmacists (ASHP). (2021). ASHP Guidelines on the Pharmacy and Therapeutics Committee and the Formulary System. <https://www.ashp.org/-/media/assets/policy-guidelines/docs/guidelines/gdl-pharmacy-therapeutics-committee-formulary-system.ashx> — the source of the formulary-system model (P&T committee review, evidence-based inclusion, formulary exceptions) this SOP follows.